

Question 7 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the role and responsibilities of an HRD professional in an organisation.

Answer

An HRD professional designs, facilitates and evaluates learning and development systems, and acts as a partner to line managers and top management.

- 1. Diagnosing development needs:** Identifying individual, team and organisational capability gaps through TNA, climate surveys and performance data.
- 2. Designing HRD systems:** Structuring appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback, counselling and OD so they work as one system.
- 3. Facilitating learning:** Arranging training, coaching, mentoring and on-the-job learning; not doing all teaching personally but enabling it.
- 4. Culture and climate building:** Promoting OCTAPAC values, trust and collaboration through interventions and role modelling.
- 5. Advisor and change agent:** Helping management handle change, technology, quality and restructuring by preparing people.
- 6. Developing line managers as developers:** Training bosses to appraise, counsel and coach, because HRD is every manager's job.
- 7. Evaluation and HRD audit:** Checking whether mechanisms actually develop people and contribute to business results.
- 8. Ethical stewardship:** Ensuring fairness in opportunities, confidentiality in counselling, and respect for employee dignity.

Conclusion. The HRD professional is therefore a system designer, facilitator, consultant and conscience-keeper of people development, not merely a training administrator.